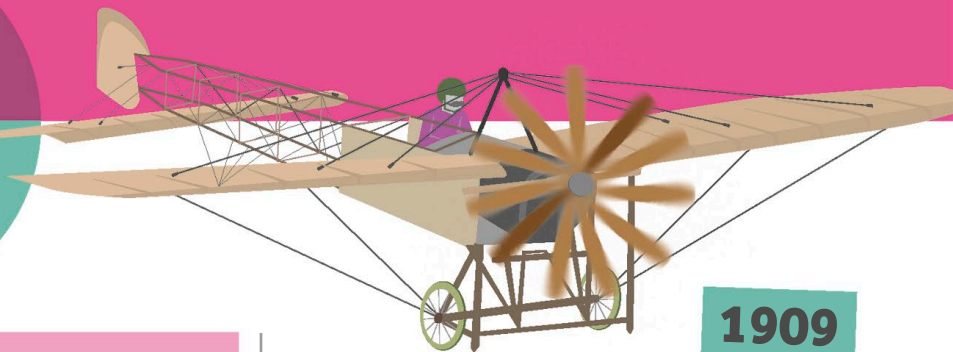


July

25



1909

Winning flight

In an achievement that won him £1,000, French aviator Louis Blériot became the first person to fly across the English Channel. He rose to fame as one of leading pilots of the era.

Born this day

1920 Rosalind Franklin, British scientist. She made huge contributions to the discovery of the double-helix structure of DNA.

1967 Matt LeBlanc, US actor. He is best known for playing Joey Tribbiani in the popular TV show *Friends*.

2006

Toumani Diabaté

The renowned Malian musician Toumani Diabaté released his famous album *Boulevard de l'Indépendance*. He was one of the first artists to record music with a *kora* (a West African stringed instrument resembling a lute).



Also on this day

1814 At the Battle of Niagara Falls (in modern-day Ontario, Canada), Canadian and British troops defended their territory against US forces.

1984 Cosmonaut (Soviet astronaut) Svetlana Savitskaya became the first woman to perform a spacewalk, while working on the Soviet Union's *Salyut 7* space station.

1984

IVF baby

Louise Brown was born in the UK. She was the world's first baby conceived by in vitro fertilization (IVF), a type of fertilization that takes place outside a woman's body.

